

Telangana : Powering India's Sporting Future



From Rural Playgrounds to Global Arenas

Telangana is steadily building a comprehensive sports ecosystem designed to nurture talent from the grassroots and develop worldclass athletes. Guided by a clear policy framework, the state is investing in infrastructure, training systems, and academic institutions to position itself as a major sporting hub in India. The initiative rests on a simple vision: **“Rural to Global – Crafting Champions.”** Through widespread infrastructure development, structured training pathways, and institutional support, the state aims to identify and train talent across districts and transform promising athletes into national and international competitors.

A Policy Framework for Sporting Excellence

The Telangana Sports Policy outlines a long-term strategy to transform the state into a power hub of sports. The policy focuses on five key pillars: **Governance & Organization, Sports Ecosystem, Long-Term Athlete Development, Infrastructure Development, Skill Development & Career Pathways.** At the administrative level, governance is strengthened through structured oversight. A dedicated sports governance framework guides planning and execution, with board meetings chaired by the Chief Minister to ensure policy direction and coordination across departments. Transparent processes and institutional accountability form the backbone of this system. The policy also emphasizes creating a structured sporting environment from village-level participation to elite competition. Partnerships with national and international institutions, along with academic integration and career support for athletes and coaches, ensure that sports development remains sustainable and professionally managed.

Building Infrastructure from Village to State Level

A defining feature of Telangana's approach is the scale of grassroots infrastructure. The state is developing 15,900 Telangana Kreedha Pranganalu (TKPs) community sports grounds that make basic facilities accessible in villages and local communities. In addition, mini stadiums are being developed in all Assembly constituencies, ensuring that athletes have access to structured training spaces close to home. These facilities create a pipeline for participation and talent identification. At the higher levels, the state is modernising stadiums and expanding specialised sports infrastructure to support training, competitions, and athlete development. Together, these initiatives create a continuum of sports infrastructure, enabling athletes to progress from local facilities to advanced training centres.

Strengthening Sports Ecosystem

The Chief Minister's Cup (CM's Cup) is the State's flagship multisport event that promotes grassroots participation & provides a structured pathway to identify & nurture sporting talent across the state. The state adopts Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) promoting the core values of Excellence, Respect, and Friendship, for PETs, PDs, and coaches, who in-turn impart these values to students. Welfare initiatives such as the Guruvandanam Scheme for coaches and the Mega Super-Speciality Health Camp support coaches & athlete well-being through accident and health insurance coverage and free advanced medical consultations and diagnostics.

Global Recognition in Football Development



Telangana's football training programme has received international recognition through the Talent Development Scheme (TDS). The state hosts a men's academy ranked second in India, while its women's academy is the first in India and the second in the world under the FIFA TDS framework. These academies provide residential training and structured development programmes for young footballers, creating a strong pipeline for National & International competition.

Academies and Sports Schools for Structured Training

Telangana has established 14 specialised sports academies and 4 sports schools across the state to provide systematic training for

young athletes. These institutions focus on disciplines such as athletics, hockey, football, handball, volleyball, cycling, wrestling, archery, boxing, judo, gymnastics, rowing, fencing, badminton, swimming, and weightlifting.



The academies combine scientific training, residential facilities, and academic education, ensuring that athletes receive holistic development. Professional coaching, structured training programmes, and performance monitoring help young athletes prepare for higher levels of competition.

Sports schools located in Hakimpet, Adilabad, Karimnagar and Hanumakonda integrate sports training with formal education, allowing student-athletes to pursue both academic and athletic excellence. A regional sports hostel in Hanumakonda supports more than 100 athletes by providing coaching, training infrastructure, and a protein-rich sports diet..

Advancing Sports Education and Research

To support the long-term growth of sports science and management, the state is establishing the Young India Physical Education and Sports University (YIPESU). The university is envisioned as a premier institution for sports education, research, and high-performance training. It aims to produce skilled professionals in sports science, coaching, and sports management. YIPESU is being developed in collaboration with leading global institutions, including Loughborough University (UK), Korea National Sport University (South Korea), and Queensland University (Australia), along with support from international partners in the United States. The university will offer degree, diploma, and certificate programmes in sports-related fields while also supporting research in sports performance and athlete development.

Placing Telangana on the Global Sports Map

Telangana is also engaging with global sports leaders through international forums and events. The Telangana Sports Conclave 2025 and the Telangana Rising Global Summit 2025, held on December 8–9 at Bharat Future City, brought together policymakers, global organisations, sports professionals, and industry leaders. The summit featured 27 sessions covering technology, sports development, economic opportunities, and infrastructure planning, with participation from global institutions including the World Health Organization and the World Bank. Key outcomes included the formal release of the Telangana Sports Policy, strategic memoranda of understanding on sports infrastructure and sports cities, and international consultations with global universities. The FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026 Qualifiers hosted in Hyderabad for the first time, with the top three teams securing qualification for the FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026 to be held in Belgium and Netherlands.

A Vision for the Future

Through policy reform, infrastructure expansion, academic collaboration, and international engagement, Telangana is laying the foundations for a strong sports ecosystem.

The state's strategy integrates grassroots participation with elite training, ensuring that talent from villages can progress through structured pathways to compete at national and global levels.

By investing in facilities, training systems, and sports education, Telangana is positioning itself not only as a centre for athletic excellence but also as a driver of India's sporting future.